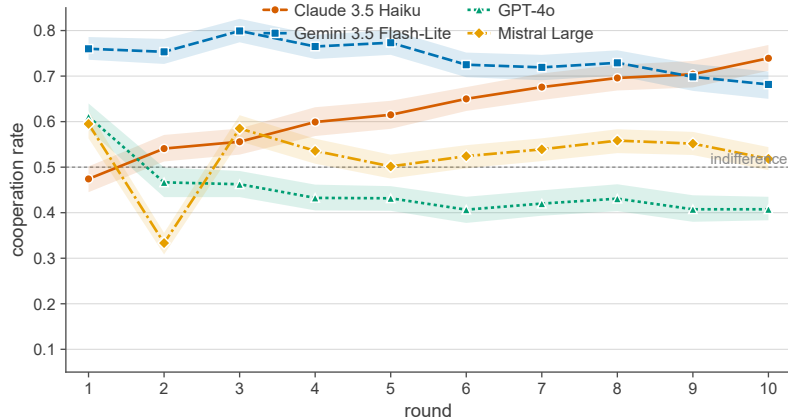


a

Trajectories diverge after the opening



Backward induction from a finite horizon predicts decay towards mutual defection. Only Claude does that (-0.27 from round 1 to round 10); GPT-4o, Mistral and Gemini all end more cooperative than they start. Gemini is the one arm that was told the round count, and it warms up rather than unravelling, so the pattern is not driven by horizon knowledge.

b

Opening versus final round

